

Gandhi showed them his ticket. He refused to leave the first-class car. The European man left again and came back with a policeman, who promptly kicked Gandhi off the train. Gandhi stood alone on the Maritzburg Station platform as the train pulled away.

The rest of the trip to Pretoria did not go much better. On a horse-drawn carriage, the white passengers did not want an Indian inside the coach with them. The coach leader told Gandhi to sit on the footboard-the small step that people used to get inside. “The insult was more than I could bear,” Gandhi wrote.